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KIDS PROGRESSION

Mastering the art of adjusting the progression is essential in teaching children to ski. While there are similarities in teaching both adults and children—particularly in understanding the 'what' and 'why'—the 'how' must be uniquely tailored to each young student's needs. Effective lessons for children require thoughtful adjustments in how we deliver information, the pace of instruction, and the balance between practice and movement. This section offers additional content tailored from the adult progression, including suggested tasks, games, and insights for engaging with younger learners.

Let's Take The Kids on an Adventure....

Early Mobility Training

Introducing children to skiing is similar to the way we do it with adults, but with a slight twist. We start by engaging them in warm-up games without their skis. These games can include tag or creating an obstacle course with poles or skis, encouraging children to hop, jump, and move around the equipment. This initial step is crucial as it enables us to observe each student's engagement in the task, their adaptability to new equipment, and their physical abilities in a controlled environment.

- Use kids' favorite pass times and references to their superheroes (e.g. Paw patrol, Dora the Explorer, etc.) which was establish in the earlier steps in the progression
- Incorporate kids' games, for examples Simon Says, Tag, Green light/red light, jump over the snow snakes

COVERT CLUE

Children find it easier to navigate around objects rather than moving freely within a space. You can create a course using ski poles, bamboo poles, or hula hoops for them to maneuver around or have the kids navigate around each other.



Free Foot Glide (one ski on, one ski off)

Engaging in single-ski activities can be a valuable learning experience for older children, offering them plenty of practice. It's important to note that this activity is not recommended for children aged 6 and under due to their limited muscle strength at a young age.

To make this experience enjoyable, consider organizing games where older children can challenge themselves to glide as far as possible on one ski. You can set up reference points using poles or cones to add some excitement. However, for children aged 6 and under, this activity can still introduce them to the concept of sliding on snow. Be mindful of the duration of the task, as it can be quite tiring for kids of this age group.

- Hopping on one foot, bouncing, tapping, building mobility as they glide on one foot.
- Hockey stops on one foot.
- Moving around in a circle—as they do, make sure they are being primed of the downhill ski (e.g. moving clockwise will help promote balance against the left foot which in turn would be the downhill ski.)
- Refer to adult Progression document for more examples of small glide, long glide, one foot. By tapping into the children's interests, you can use games to achieve similar outcomes effectively.

COVERT CLUE

Provide ample time for children to master these exercises/drills and acquire the essential skills. Continuously offer individualized feedback and encouragement to all the skiers, as some may require more support than others. Celebrate this huge milestone they are SLIDING!!!



Two-Foot Glide (both skis on)



When teaching children at this stage, it's crucial to select the right terrain. Opt for a gently sloping, mostly flat surface with natural stopping points if necessary. Additionally with children, it's not only about choosing the appropriate terrain but also finding a tranquil spot close to restroom facilities (please refer to the resort's bathroom policy) or a place for kids to warm up. Those hot chocolate breaks are a must!

Moving children is essential to keep them engaged. By incorporating various elements of the environment and terrain, you can encourage children to learn through exploration and physical activity. This approach allows them to develop skills naturally by moving sideways across the hill or mastering the ascent back up the slope.

- Shuffling, small glide, long glide, hands on the knees, head shoulder knees and toes, tapping one foot at a time, ski pole duck under, dragging poles.

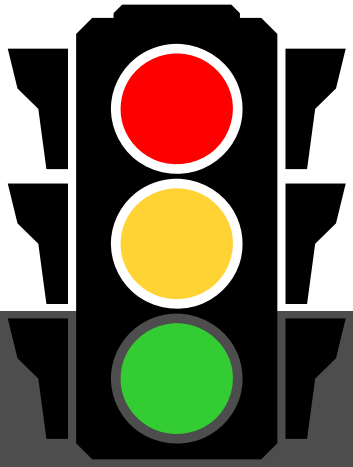
COVERT CLUE

Once your children reach a certain age, you can gradually introduce more intricate tasks, like refining their gliding abilities. Honing fundamental skills will pave the way for sustained improvement and having them practice side-stepping uphill will nurture strong edging skills.

The Braking Snowplow

Introducing the **Braking Snowplow** to children marks a significant achievement for our students, fostering a sense of freedom for them. We've unlocked the key! When introducing Braking Snowplow to kids on flat terrain, it's crucial to invest ample time in building their understanding of movement before allowing them to slide. This step helps children grasp the fundamentals of maneuvering to achieve controlled slowing down. Through repetitive practice with varying wedge sizes, ranging from as small as a mouse-sized gap at the tips to as large as a dinosaur-sized gap at the ski tails, students can fine-tune their speed control. Engaging in interactive games will also help students observe the consequences of crossing their ski tips or having too wide a gap. This focus on safety is paramount as we eventually will guide children around the mountain.

Hands on the knees, copy hands movement, mouse tip size in front, elephant size at the back, red light stop reference for big braking pl0w, green light for small braking plow reference, hopping, bouncing, dragging poles, squash the bugs between shin and ski boots.



COVERT CLUE

Using an Edgie- Wedgie to hold the ski tips is a fantastic method to introduce children to the Braking Snowplow.

Single Turn (Isolated) Direction Change

As we begin introducing **single turns**, reaching this milestone is a significant achievement! Let's celebrate with enthusiasm and excitement as we play games to guide young learners in changing their direction successfully. It's crucial to focus on explaining the "what to do" rather than the "how to do it" when teaching children. Incorporating frequent demonstrations of the turning motion during games will allow you to celebrate your students' first turns. It's essential not to strive for perfection, encourage them to turn in the opposite direction soon after starting to turn one way to keep them in motion. At this stage, we can also introduce the concept of outside ski balance to help children understand the sensations in their feet. You can have them identify which foot feels heavier, which feels lighter, as a simple way to check their ski balance and understanding.

Basketball drill, pet the dog, squish the bug with the shins, two hands on outside knee, convex terrain, gentle half pipe shape terrain.

COVERT CLUE

If a child is having difficulty changing direction, suggest they take small steps around the turn. Allowing a bit of momentum to cover slightly greater distances can make it simpler to execute the single leg turn.

Two Turn Sequence

As children transition from one skill level to another, their excitement is palpable, marking a significant milestone. It's essential to celebrate their progress. However, instructors must also be mindful, especially with first-time skiers, as fatigue can become a significant factor at this stage. Ensuring the well-being of children, both physically and emotionally, is crucial. All the milestones we've celebrated can be overshadowed by poor choices. Remember, as confidence grows in mastering **two-turn sequences**, managing their energy levels becomes key. Creating the right environment is essential for children to continue progressing and enjoying the sport of skiing.

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→ Hop between turns, bounce between turns, appropriate terrain and speed to aid in balance against the outside ski, chipmunks in the woods, vary turn shapes, use small bumps and spines to aid flow.



COVERT CLUE

During this stage of development, it's important to consider that snow conditions are a crucial factor. If there's a bit of fresh powder, you can encourage a smaller wedge, more S-shaped turns down the hill, while on firmer snow, a rounder C-shaped turn is more suitable. You can make it fun for children by having them draw in the snow to demonstrate these techniques, making it an exciting part of their adventure.

The First Lift Experience

Prioritize safety above all else when approaching lifts for the first time. It is essential to check with your ski hill regarding loading procedures before proceeding to the loading area. If you notice that children are becoming fatigued during the day and there is any doubt about their energy level, it's advisable to remain in the beginner area. Make the experience of going on the lift a positive and enjoyable part of the kids' adventure.



Before entering the loading area, guide the children to the side so they can observe and describe what's happening. Remember to shuffle into line, look back to prepare for loading the chair, sit back in the seat, and lower the safety bar. If at any point you have concerns or require assistance, do not hesitate to ask a lift attendant for help, especially when loading a child onto the chair.

COVERT CLUE

When seeking assistance from an adult to help transport a child on a ski lift, observe the adult's equipment and how they handle the lift line. For instance, if someone is struggling with rental equipment and appears uncomfortable moving along the line, consider not asking for their help. It's perfectly fine if someone declines your request for assistance; exercise patience until you find a willing and suitable person.

Multi Turn Sequence

The multi-turn sequence represents a significant milestone for children, as it's the point at which they experience a sense of freedom while skiing. This is a time when family and friends can join them on their adventure. When working with younger children, the terrain plays a crucial role. As an instructor, you can guide them in making the right turns and controlling their speed. However, it's equally important to choose the correct path down the hill, using berms or small rollers to shift their weight correctly, creating an exciting sensation of linking turns together. Utilizing small bumps as a mobility aid is a valuable tool for young children.

As children grow older, involving them in the decision-making process empowers them to take on a leadership role in their own learning journey, ultimately strengthening the bond and trust between you and your students. We are not searching for the perfect wedge skiing, consider adding additional elements into their skiing experience to help maintain the flow and the joy of descending the mountain.

- Follow the leader, hops, bouncing, watch and do approach, experimentation (safely) dragging poles, skiing with no poles, touch knee, hip.
- Play with the terrain.



COVERT CLUE

When adventuring with younger children, keep a watchful eye on their energy levels. Stay within proximity to restroom facilities and warm-up spots. Embrace the joy of exploration!

Wedge Turn Versatility

In this stage of the children's progression, particularly with young ones, it's essential not to emphasize generating varying sizes, which facilitates terrain play. For instance, when skiing on flat terrain, using a smaller wedge is necessary to maintain speed. This is where we can introduce the concept of ridge lines to assist children in naturally balancing against the outside ski. Many children, especially those under the age of six, lack the muscular structure to ski in parallel, so instead of striving for perfection, encourage them to embrace the adventure.

COVERT CLUE

This is an ideal moment to revisit the adult progression to gain a more profound insight into the results of Wedge Versatility, which in turn, will empower you to navigate your adventure's terrain more effectively.

The First Match

When children experience the thrill of their skis aligning in parallel, it's a source of immense joy. This milestone in young skiers' journeys often involves a strategic approach, where they choose their speed and turn shape to balance effectively on the outside ski. As they gain control over their inside leg, aligning their skis parallel becomes a natural progression. The games listed below are designed to support this skill development. Remember, choosing the right terrain is key to ensuring children can comfortably and safely master this technique.



- Tapping of the inside ski, squashing the bug, petting the dog, hand on outside hip, basketball, swords with the poles, hand on outside knee. small bumps.



COVERT CLUE

Pick the correct terrain, turn shape and speed, and when you have children balanced against the downhill ski, the other ski will match naturally. Pick the flat terrain and allow your kids to feel some speed in their skiing and bingo the skis will start to match like magic.

Parallel Skiing

You've achieved it! This marks a significant milestone for your kids—they're now proficient parallel skiers. Their skiing journey is about to get even more exciting as they explore the entire mountain, savoring all the beautiful aspects of this beloved sport. The connections you've forged with your children will serve as the foundation for lifelong skiing adventures. While celebrating with your kids, keep the enthusiasm soaring! This is a monumental achievement! As they continue to progress, it's the point where you shift from a focus on drills and exercises to emphasizing outcomes. Encourage them to play with the terrain, master short turns, long turns, and conquer bumps – the mountain is now their playground.

- Rollerblade turns, jump turns, 360's on snow, switch skiing, hockey stops with pole plant



COVERT CLUE

As your children progress in their adventures and master various drills and exercises, there's no need to change them. Instead, you can make them more challenging. For instance, if they're comfortable with one-leg skiing, removing their poles and skiing on a single leg can add a new level of complexity to the exercise. This foundation of skills will serve them well in the future.



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